

Lanning and now Harmanpreet. How do their leadership styles compare?

Meg and Harman, as leaders, are extremely competitive. They lead from the front. For a coach, when you have either of these players as your skipper, you know that 95 per cent of the time they're going to make the right call under pressure. For me, it's a perfect scenario.

I will get my Harmanpreet match experience soon, but what I've seen with Meg (**pic, right**) is that when she doesn't get something right, and it's not without thought, she will put her hand up and say she made the wrong call. She takes that on herself. From what we've seen so far, players want to play for leaders like Meg and Harman, which is so important. I'll have more to draw from at the end of the league.

As a WPL coach, what has been your biggest challenge?

Boundary sizes! It's challenging as a coach. But realistically, the language barrier is one. At DC, all players spoke English. In Mumbai, we do have three or four players who don't, which has been challenging. But it's part of what I signed up for when coming here and wanting to guide this side. We have a really good staff helping on that front.

The first year with a new team is always hectic. The priority is to be

clear and communicate roles and execution clearly to players. Mumbai is very clear that it wants to defend the title, so setting up for that ambition is very exciting. Even though you feel the pressure, I actually like it. It reminds me of when I played. You have to turn up and put in a performance. If it doesn't happen, you have to work it out.

India is often described as a future global powerhouse in women's

cricket. Has it truly caught up?

I think the WPL is pretty much what India was missing. It allows domestic players to perform under pressure, and it is big pressure. The league sets expectations very high. India has caught up across platforms with England and Australia.

The domestic system ably supports the national team. People often say two to three years, but India is already very much up there with the rest.



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« Most players, at some point, want to play cricket in India because the people are so passionate about the game. To come and experience that is different from any other competition in the world. The crowds, the hype, the involvement of the owners, it's all something special to experience – Lisa »

